

EXTERIOR

The Centurion was memorably described by a former crewman as a tank “with a soul”: for many crewmen, it was remembered with affection and considered the last generation of tank that the crew could repair themselves with standard tools. The ability of broken-down or knocked-out tanks to be recovered and repaired ready for a following day’s battle was one of the reasons the Israeli Army thought very highly of the vehicle. The commander’s cupola can counter-rotate against the position of the turret to allow him to keep eyes on a target while the turret moves.

1. Fire extinguisher release 2. Headlight cluster—outer light is infrared to assist with night driving 3. Front drive sprocket 4. Covers for driver’s periscopes 5. Gunner’s sight aperture 6. Infrared /white light searchlight 7. Loader’s periscope 8. Commander’s cupola with hatch closed 9. Smoke grenade launchers 10. Infantry telephone box 11. Fishtail exhaust

